

NEXTGEN STARTUP CHALLENGE 2026

TEAM 6

SOUND SNYC

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ABSHIRA, NOLAN, TAYLOR, TONY, WAYNE

A woman with dark hair, wearing a light-colored trench coat, stands in the rain holding a large black umbrella. She has a sad expression on her face. In the background, other people are waiting under umbrellas, and a bus stop sign is visible. The scene is set on a city street at night with blurred lights from buildings and traffic.

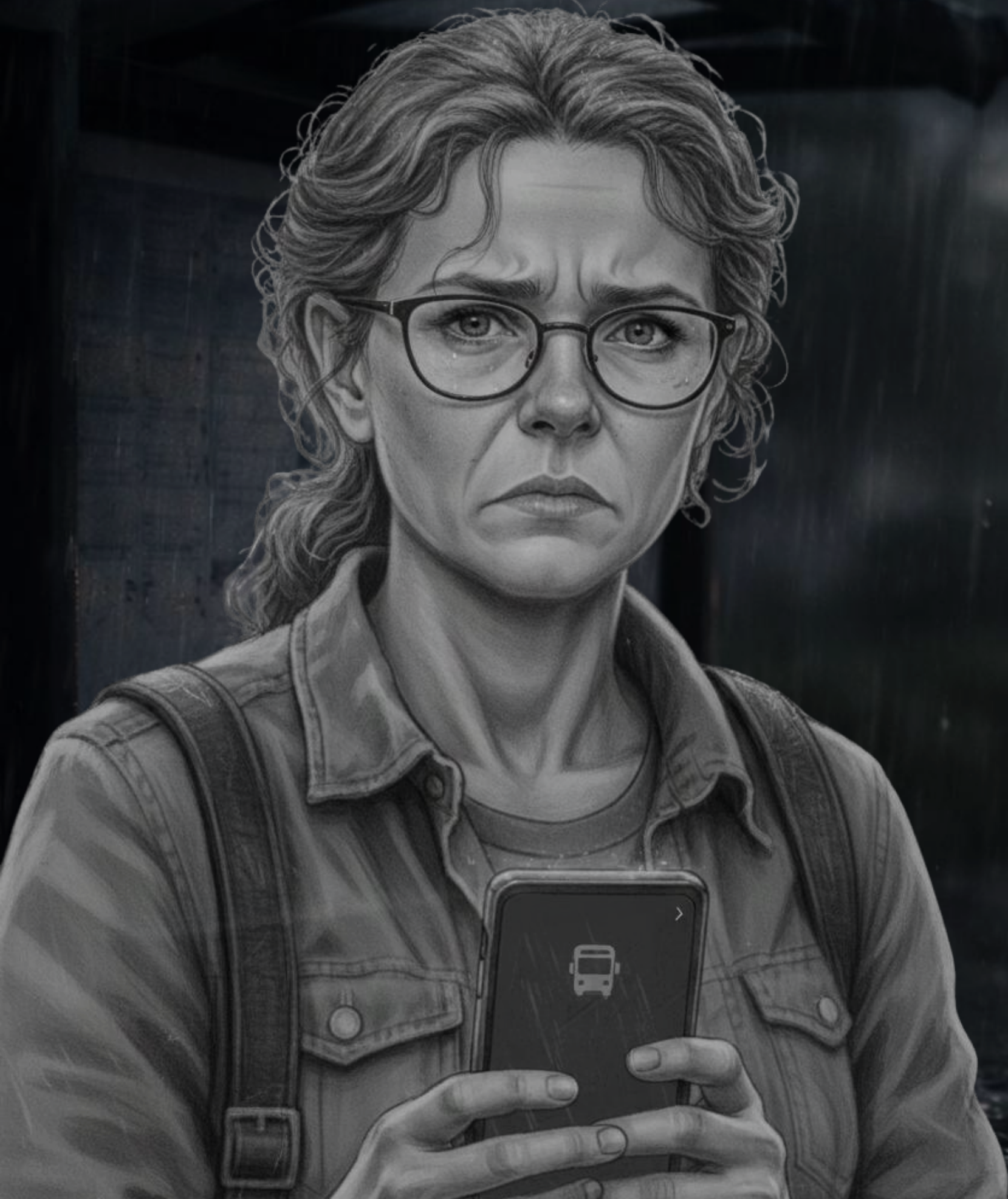
**“A BUS DELAY IS NOT JUST A FEW LOST MINUTES.
IT MEANS LATE ARRIVALS,
MISSED CONNECTIONS,
AND A DISRUPTED DAILY RHYTHM.”**

Person

a

Maria,
a 40-year-old server,
risks losing her job

when her bus app fails
to provide delay information
as she waits for the bus to get to work



Ghost Bus

A woman with glasses and curly hair is looking at a smartphone at a bus stop at night. In the background, a bus stop sign is visible with the text "8 Downtown" and "Arriving in 1 min".

King County Council Wants Fewer 'Ghost' Buses and Better Data Collection

By Stephen Fesler - March 19, 2025

The King County Council wants to zap the frequency of “ghost” buses, which are the bane of many transit riders’ existence. A ghost bus is when buses that are scheduled, and even appear inbound on transit apps, never actually come.

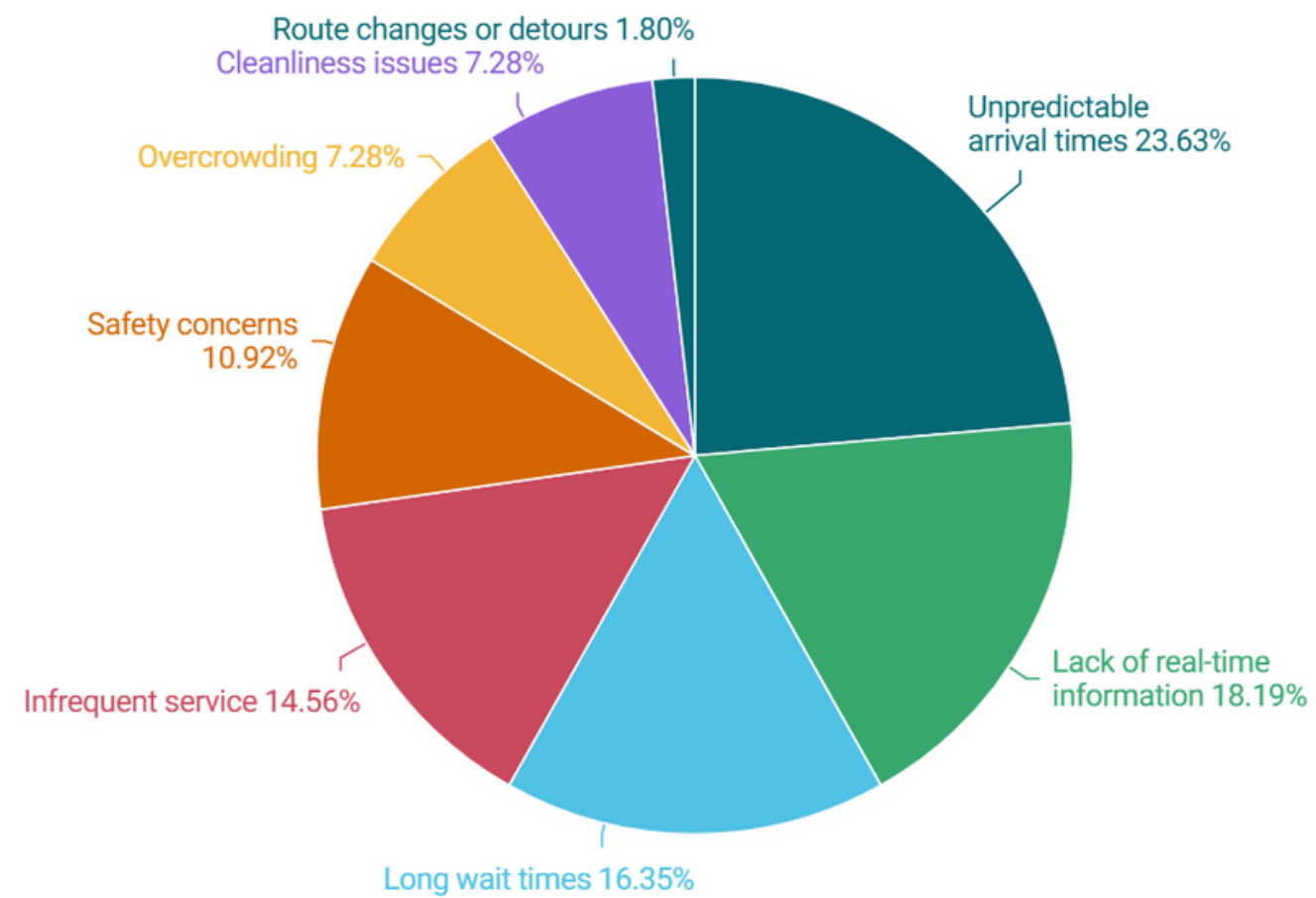
GHOST BUS:

When a bus appears as arriving in transit app, but never shows up in reality.

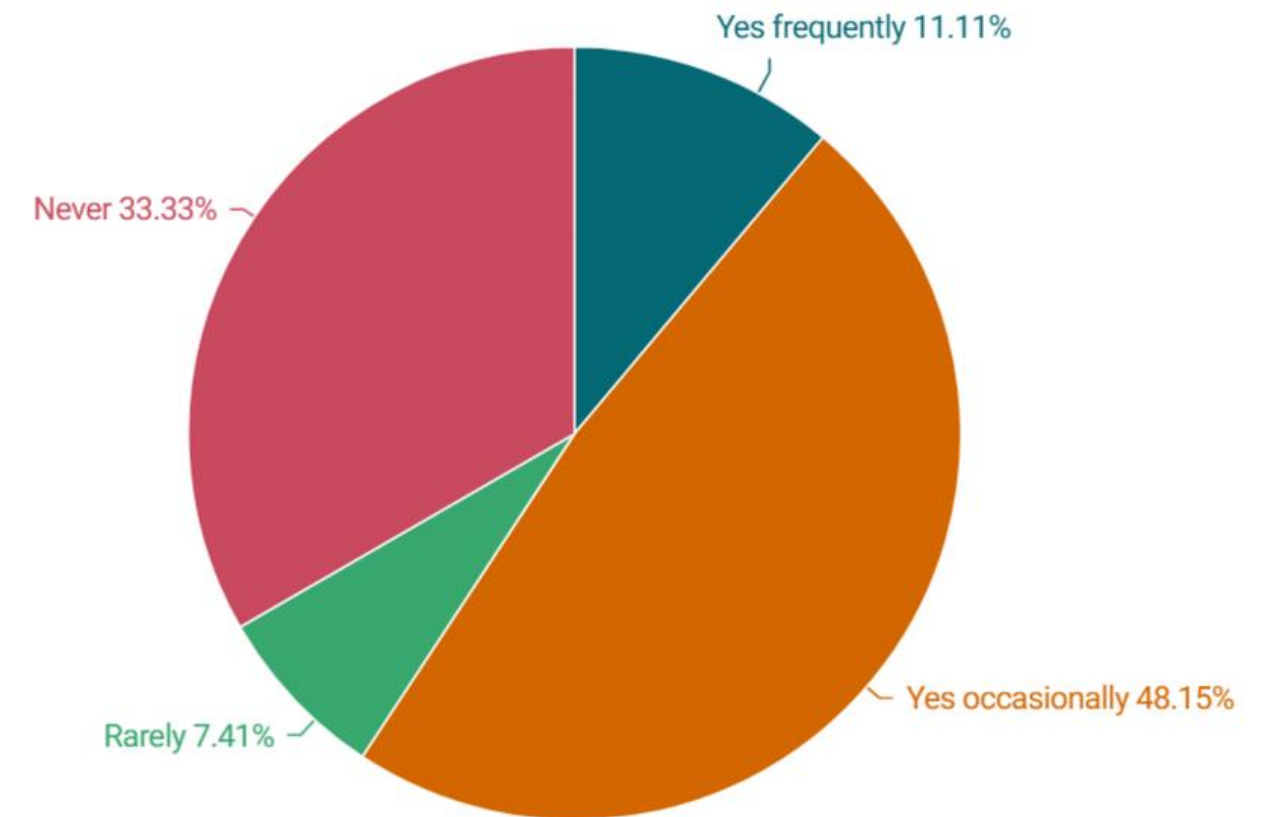


Survey

Frustrations while using public transit



Have you experienced situations where information was not updated in time?



Survey

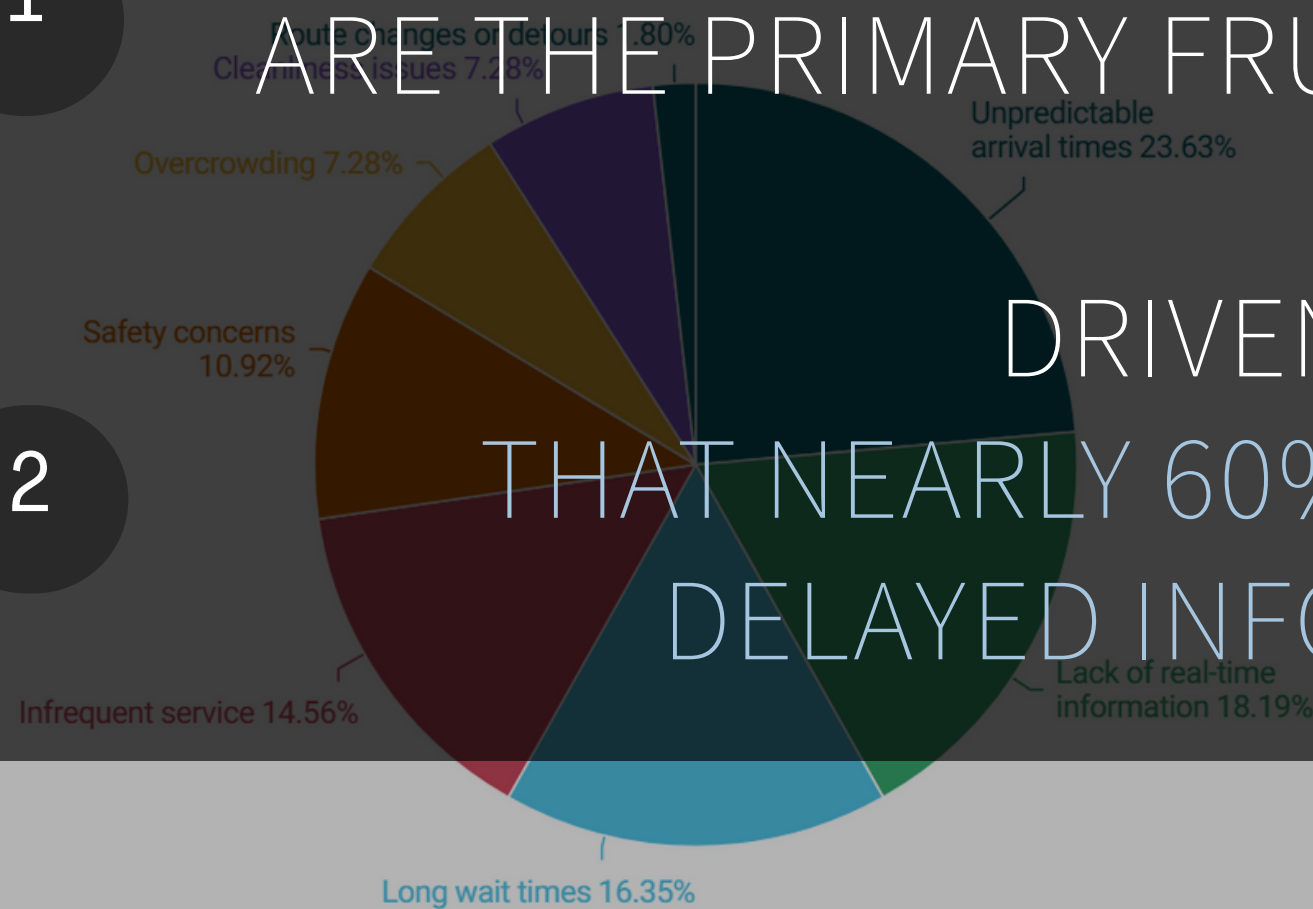
1

Frustrations while using public transit

1

UNPREDICTABLE ARRIVAL TIMES (23.6%)
ARE THE PRIMARY FRUSTRATION FOR COMMUTERS,

2



2

Have you experienced situations where not updated in time?

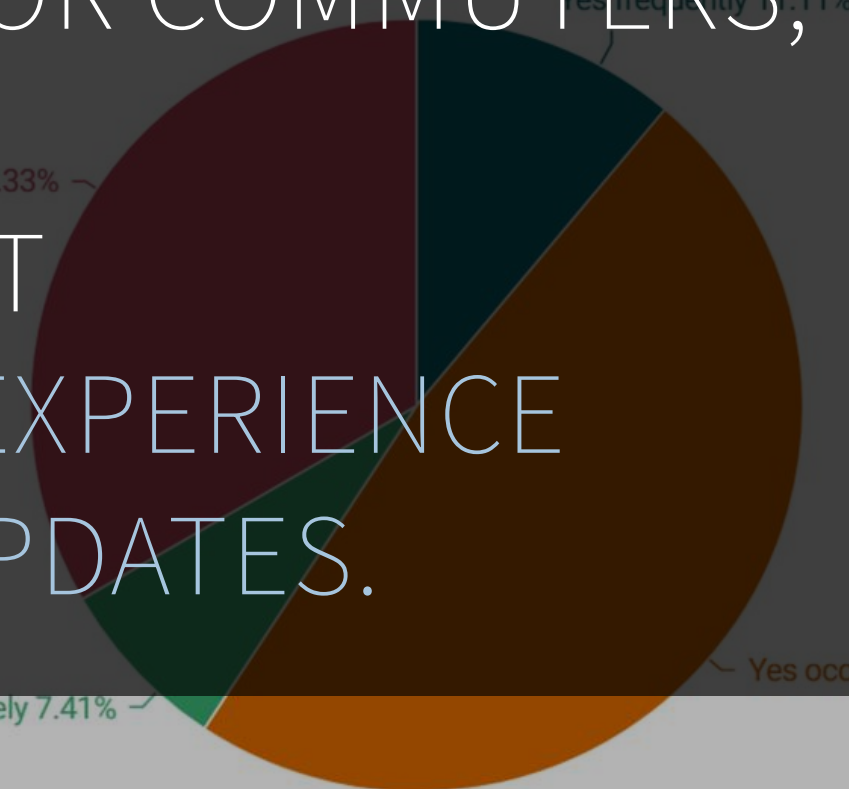
Never 33.33%

Rarely 7.41%

Yes occasionally 48.15%

Yes frequently 11.11%

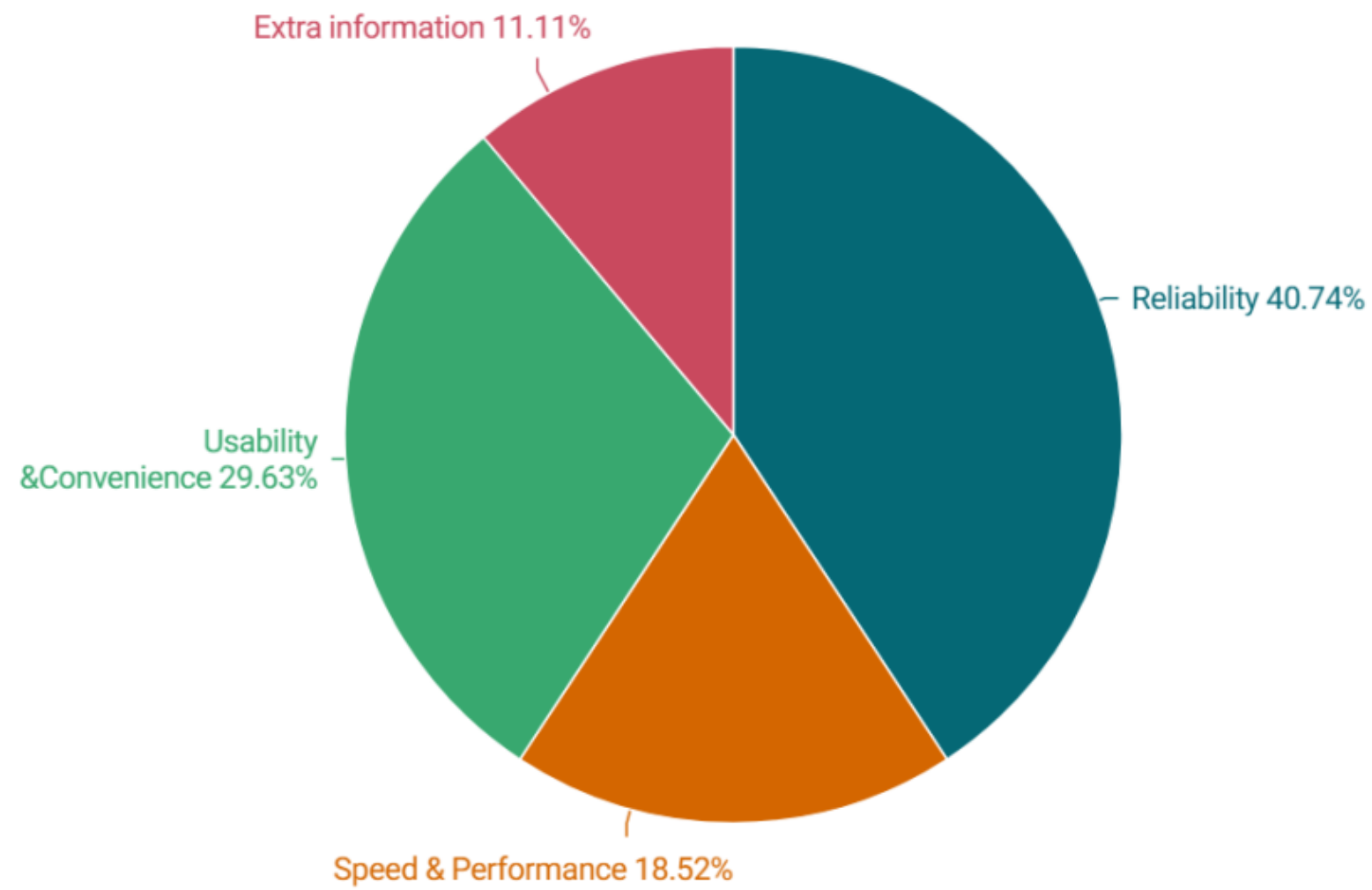
Never 33.33%



DRIVEN BY THE FACT
THAT NEARLY 60% OF USERS EXPERIENCE
DELAYED INFORMATION UPDATES.

Field Research

What factors influence your decision to download a map app?



Reliability is the most critical factor for users (40.7%), followed by Usability and convenience (29.6%).

Interview

Q. Since hardware limitations hinder accurate bus tracking, how can software still provide value?



Michael Williams
Data Scientist
University of Washington • Sound Transit

Software can provide "[contextual value](#)" by integrating 3rd-party data sources. Even if the bus hardware is lacking, software can pull in data on construction, traffic incidents, or major public events to explain why a delay is happening. By informing riders about these external factors, software helps them understand the situation even when real-time vehicle data is unavailable.

Synthesis

STEP 1: PROBLEM DEFINITION (FROM SURVEY)
HIGH UNCERTAINTY & FRUSTRATION

STEP 2: USER CORE VALUE (FROM FIELD RESEARCH)
RELIABILITY OVER FEATURES

STEP 3: STRATEGIC SOLUTION (FROM INTERVIEW)
CONTEXTUAL VALUE VIA SOFTWARE

We validated our hypotheses based on the gathered insights to formulate the solution.

Hypothesis

WEATHER IS THE PRIMARY
CAUSE OF BUS DELAYS

REAL-TIME BUS DATA IS
RELIABLE

DELAYS ARE EVENLY
DISTRIBUTED



Hypothesis

WEATHER IS THE PRIMARY
CAUSE OF BUS DELAYS



WEATHER IS A CONSTANT,
NOT A KEY VARIABLE

REAL-TIME BUS DATA IS
RELIABLE

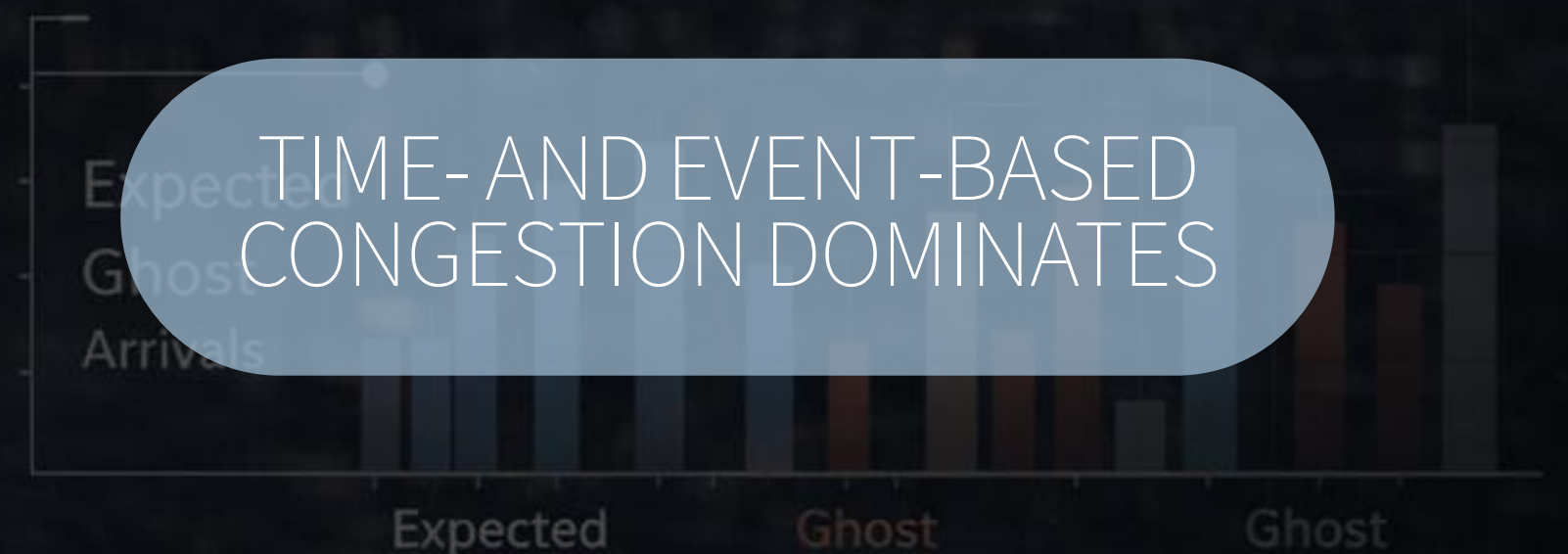


OUTDATED SENSORS FAIL
TO TRANSMIT DATA

DELAYS ARE EVENLY
DISTRIBUTED



TIME- AND EVENT-BASED
CONGESTION DOMINATES



SOUND SYNC



Real-time Integrated Bus Information System

Function

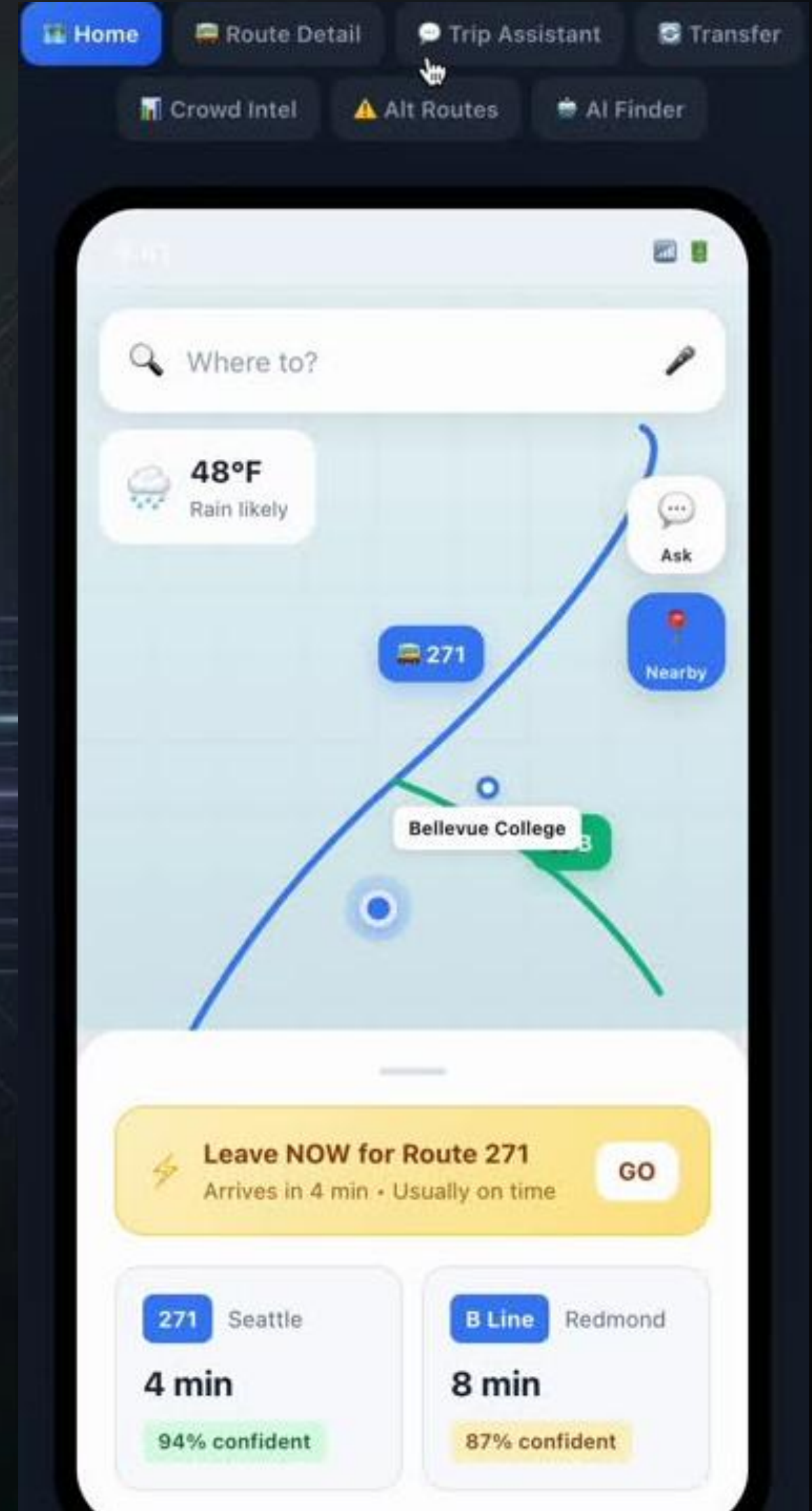
SoundSync's Key Functions

AI-Powered Route Prediction

Natural language interaction
with AI Transfer time prediction

Crowdsourced real-time
passenger data

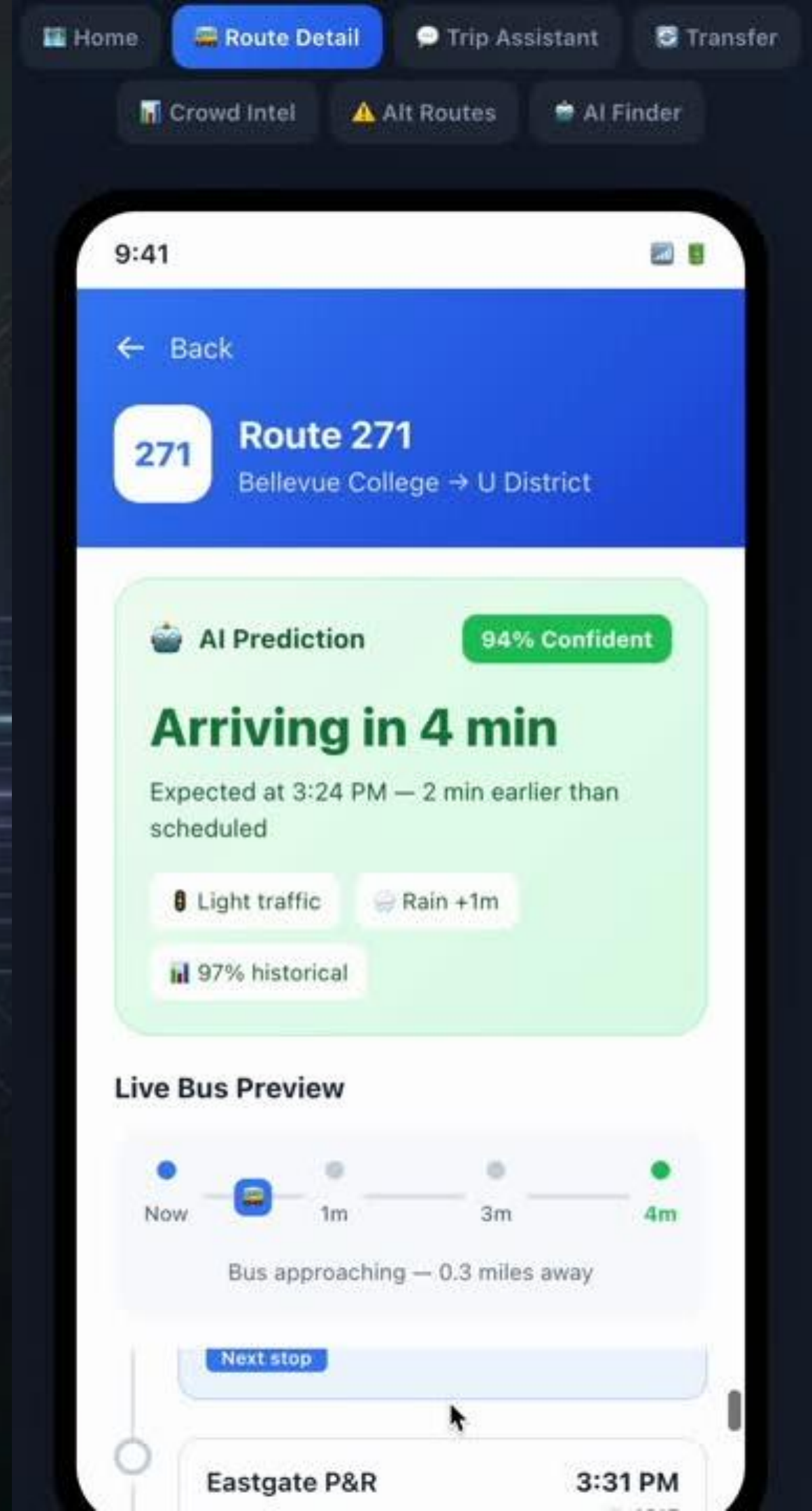
Combined with AI
for optimal routing



Function 1

AI-Powered Route Prediction

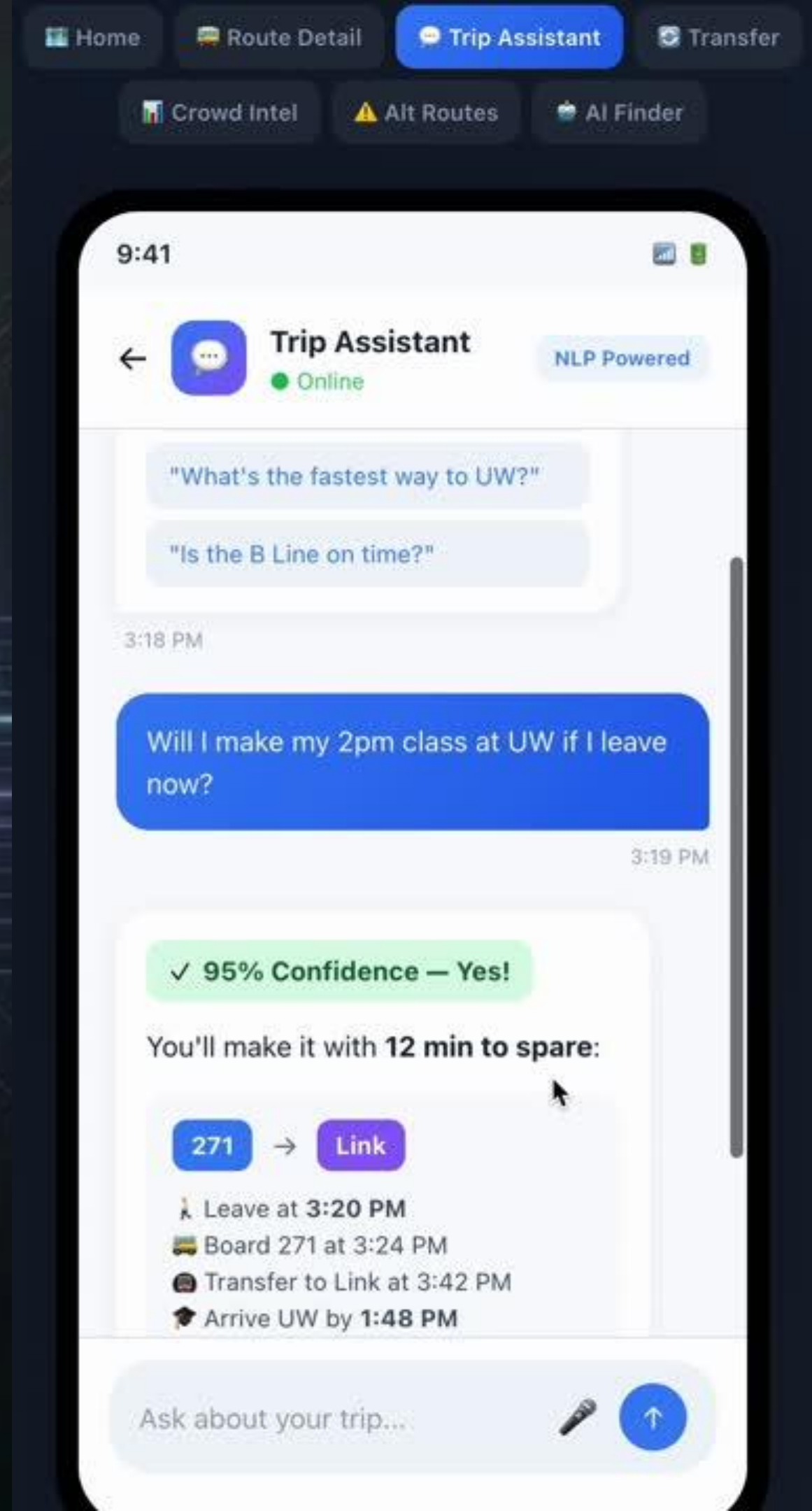
Predicts the optimal routes using smart AI analysis



Function 2

Natural language interaction
with AI Transfer time prediction

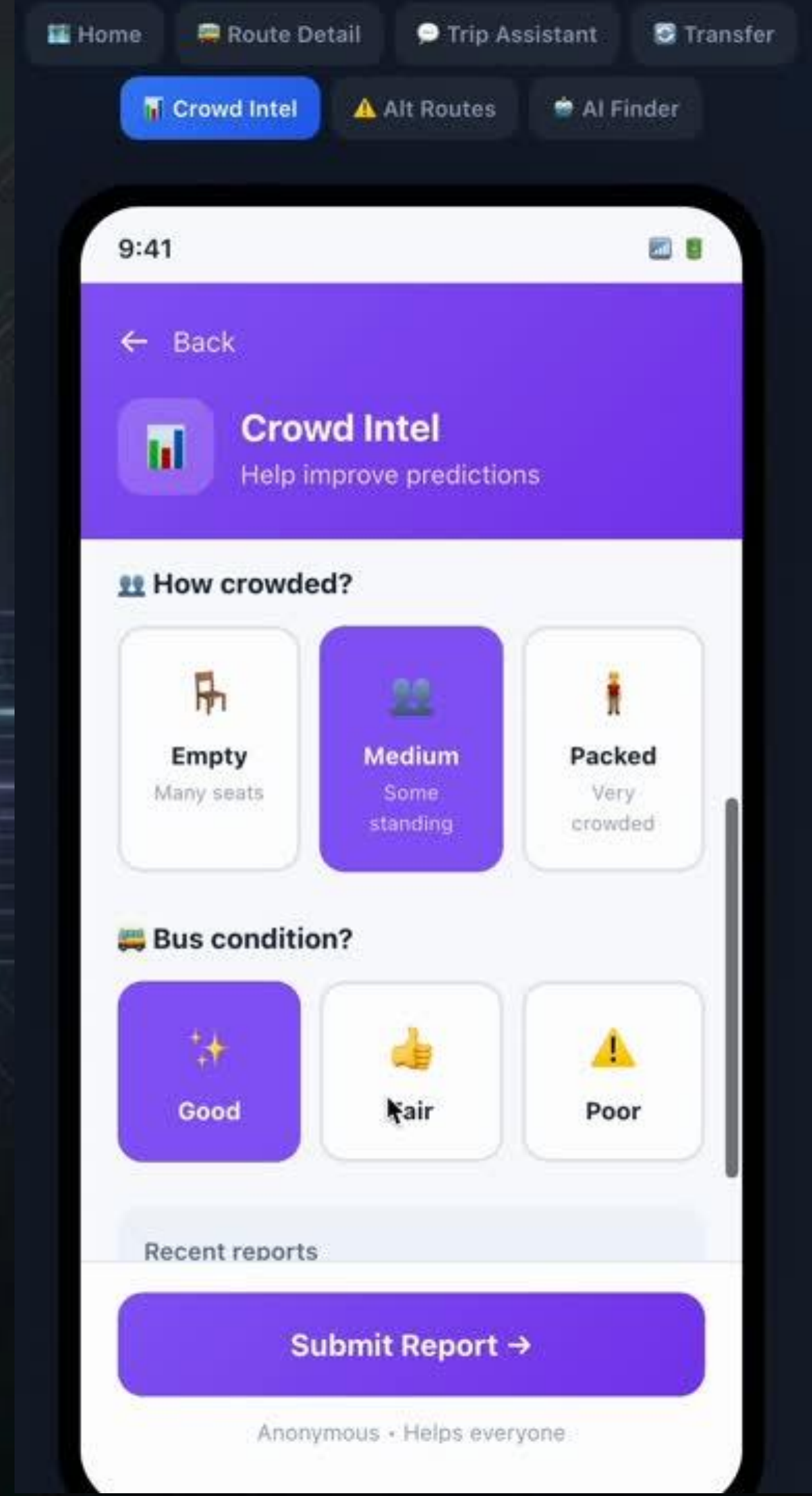
Chat naturally to get instant transfer time estimates



Function 3

Crowdsourced real-time passenger data

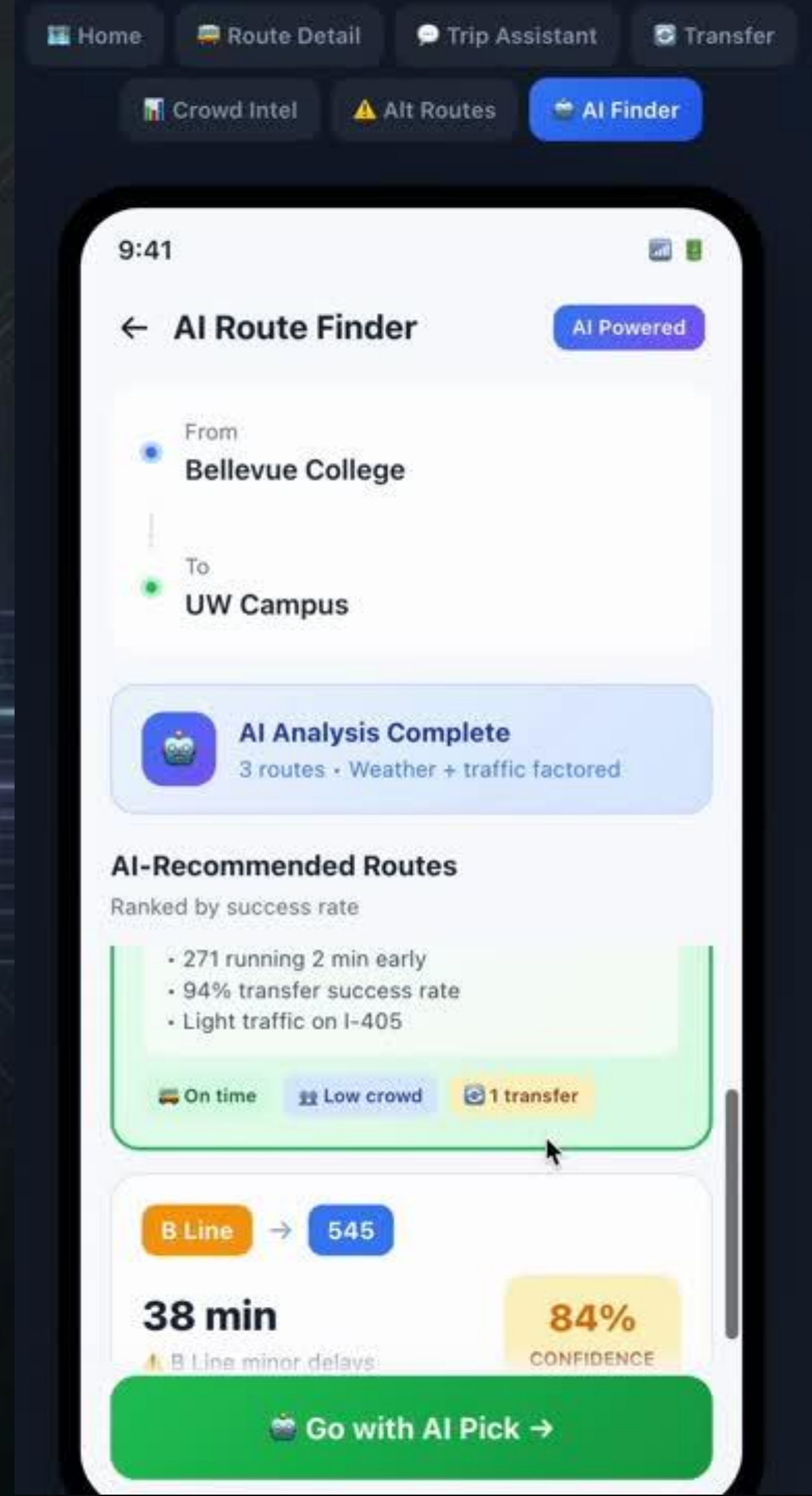
Uses live community data to track passenger flow



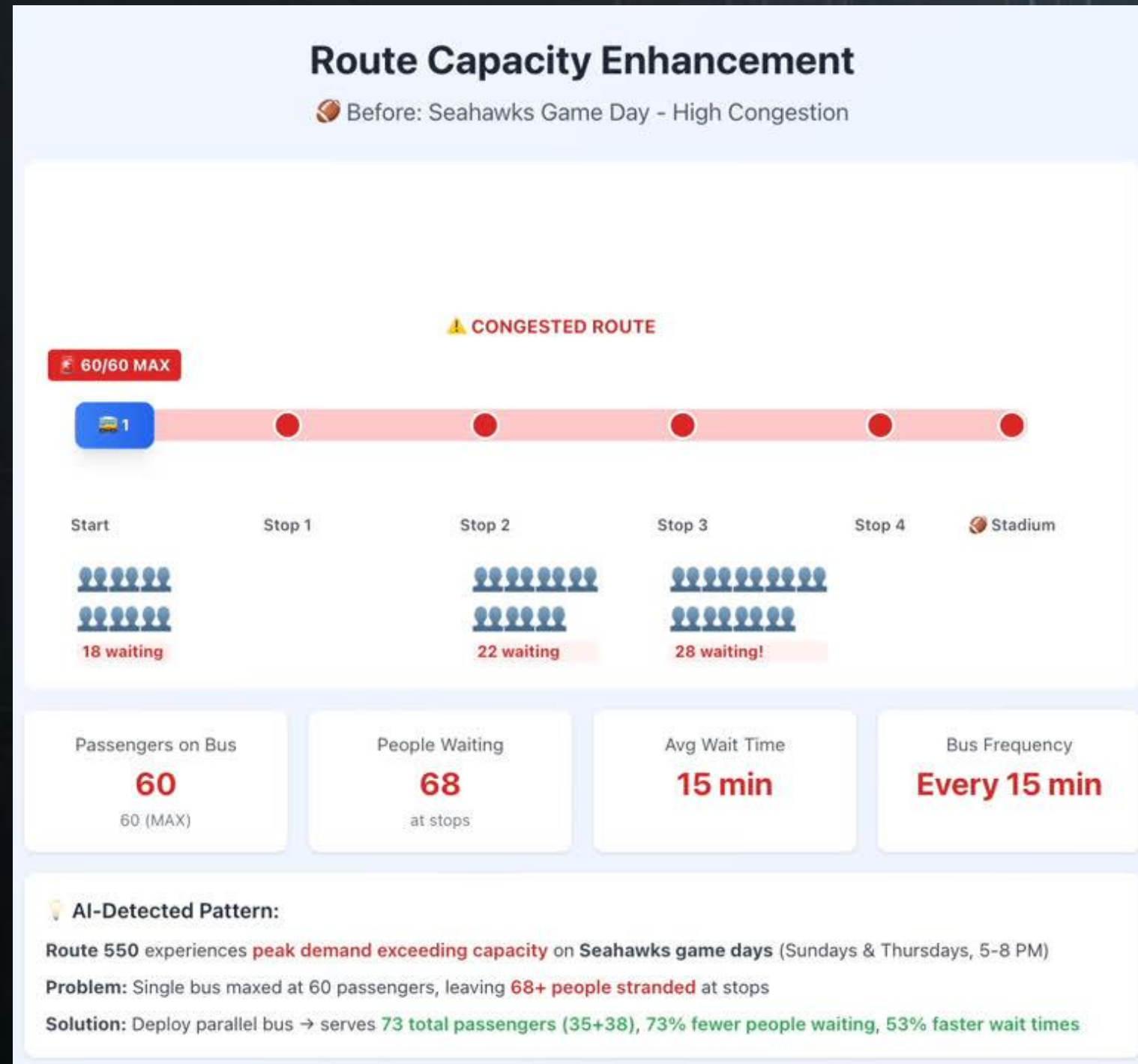
Function 4

Combined with AI
for optimal routing

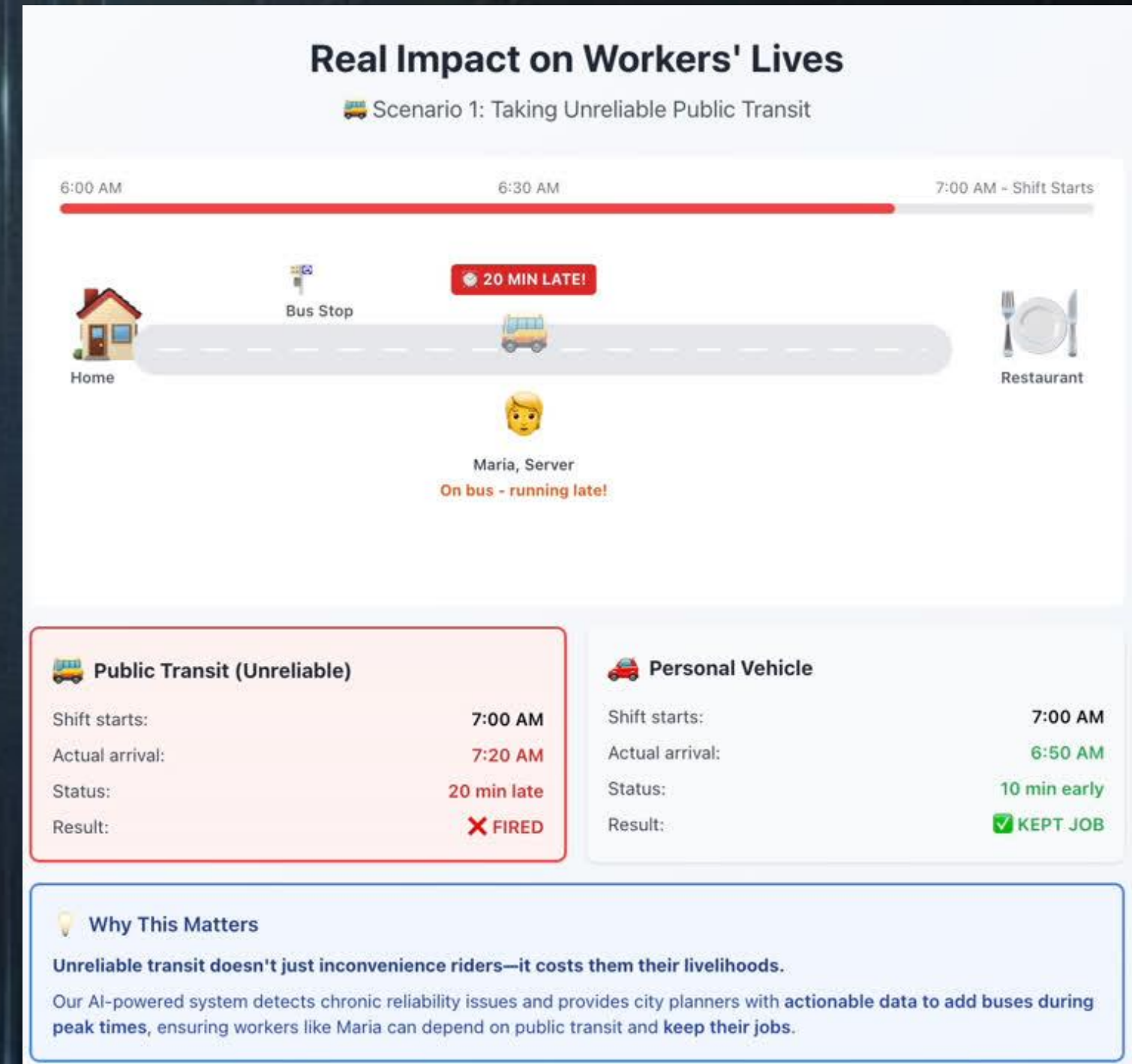
Syncs all data with AI to find your best path



City

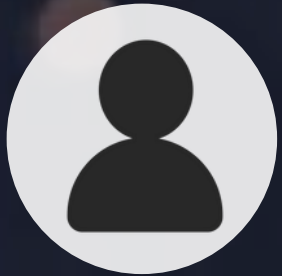


Citizen



A Win-Win Solution for the City and Citizens

Conclusion

	Daily Commuter	Gain Point  Elimination of Uncertainty & Psychological Stability	Pain Point Lateness and Stress caused by "Ghost Buses"
	City Gov / Transit Authority	Data-driven Efficient Budget Execution	Data Gaps caused by Outdated Sensors
	Market	Exclusive Data Assets & Revenue Generation	Limitations of Existing Giant Platforms

Competitive Analysis

Key Differentiators

Feature	Google / OneBusAway	Our Service
Data Source	Institutional Data (GTFS/Static)	Hybrid (Institutional + User-Crowdsourced)
Incident Response	Delayed (Dependent on agency updates)	Instant (Real-time user reports)
Reliability	Fails if agency sensors/GPS go dark	Resilient (Users cover sensor blind spots)
Contextual Awareness	Low (Misses rallies, small roadworks)	High (Accidents, construction, events)

Business Model

Short term :
Monetization & Engagement

- **Local Banner Ads:**

Generate revenue through targeted advertisements for local businesses.

- **Crowdsourcing Rewards:**

Reinvest profits to incentivize user participation and data accuracy.

Core Tech:
AI-Driven Analytics

- **Data Integration:**

Collect real-time transit data via APIs and user crowdsourcing.

- **Correlation Analysis:**

Use AI to analyze patterns between weekdays, weather, and passenger density.

Long-term:
B2G Data Solutions

- **Data-as-a-Service (DaaS):**

Sell high-level traffic intelligence and predictive metrics to city governments.

- **Policy Optimization:**

Enable data-backed decisions, such as increasing bus frequency on specific high-delay days.

TEAM 6

One Team !!



Sol



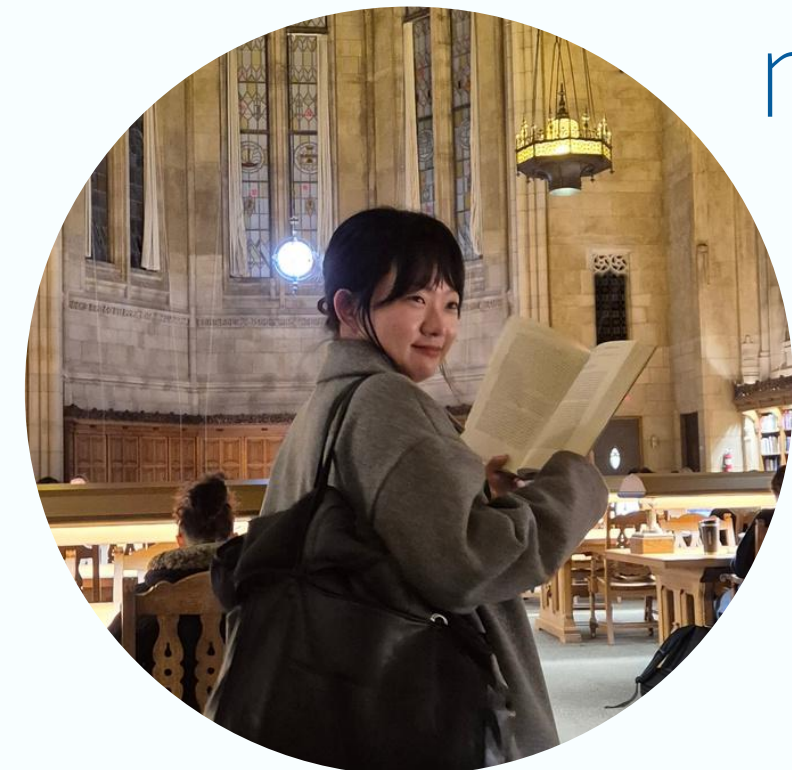
Taein



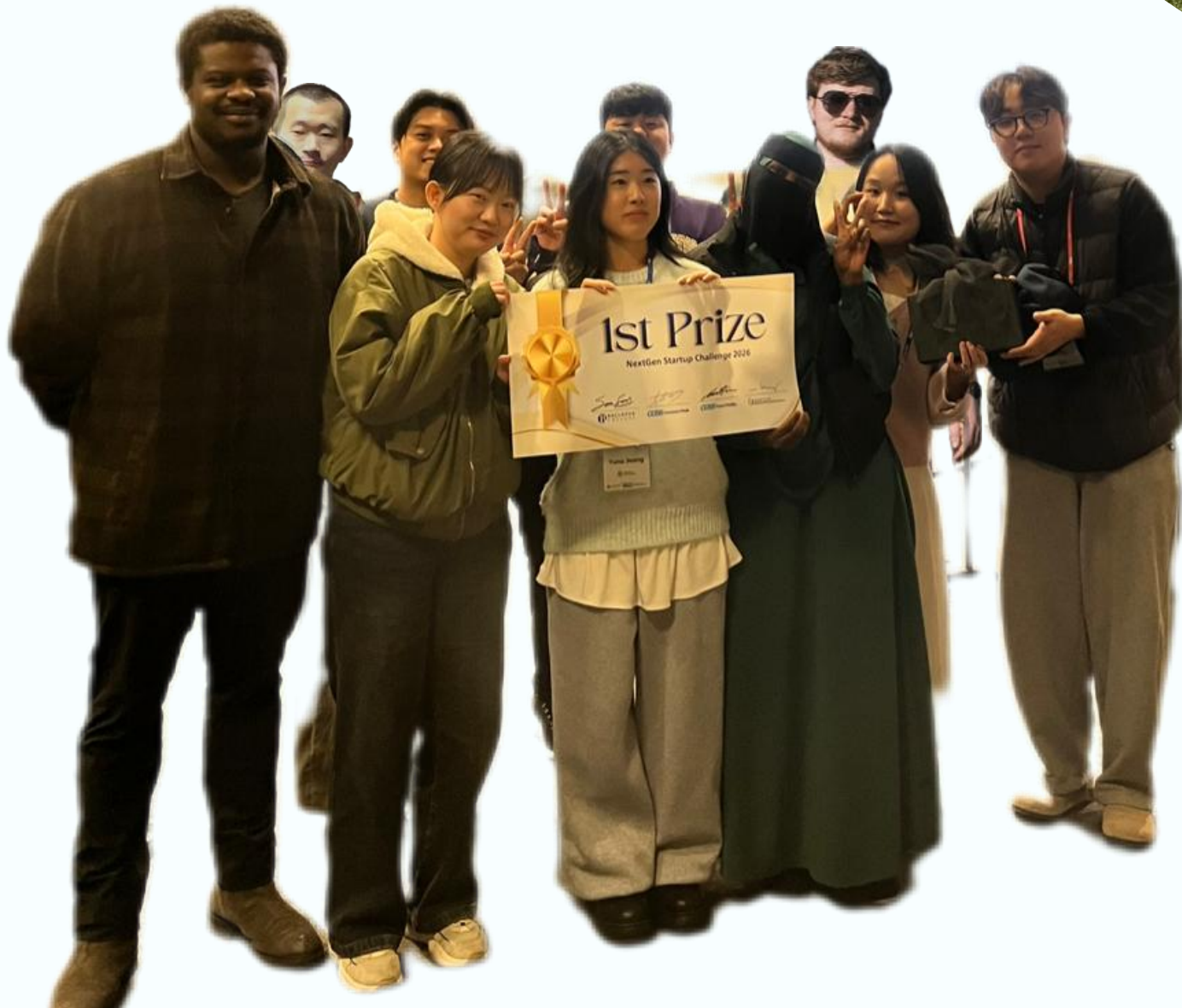
Dongyun



Yun



Suhyun



TEAM 6

One Team !!



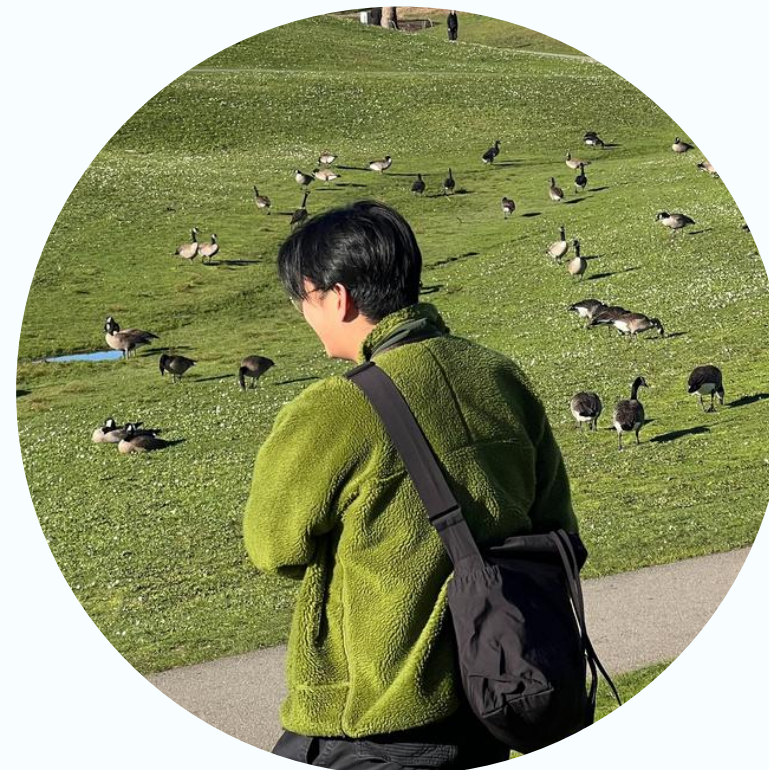
Tony



Abshira



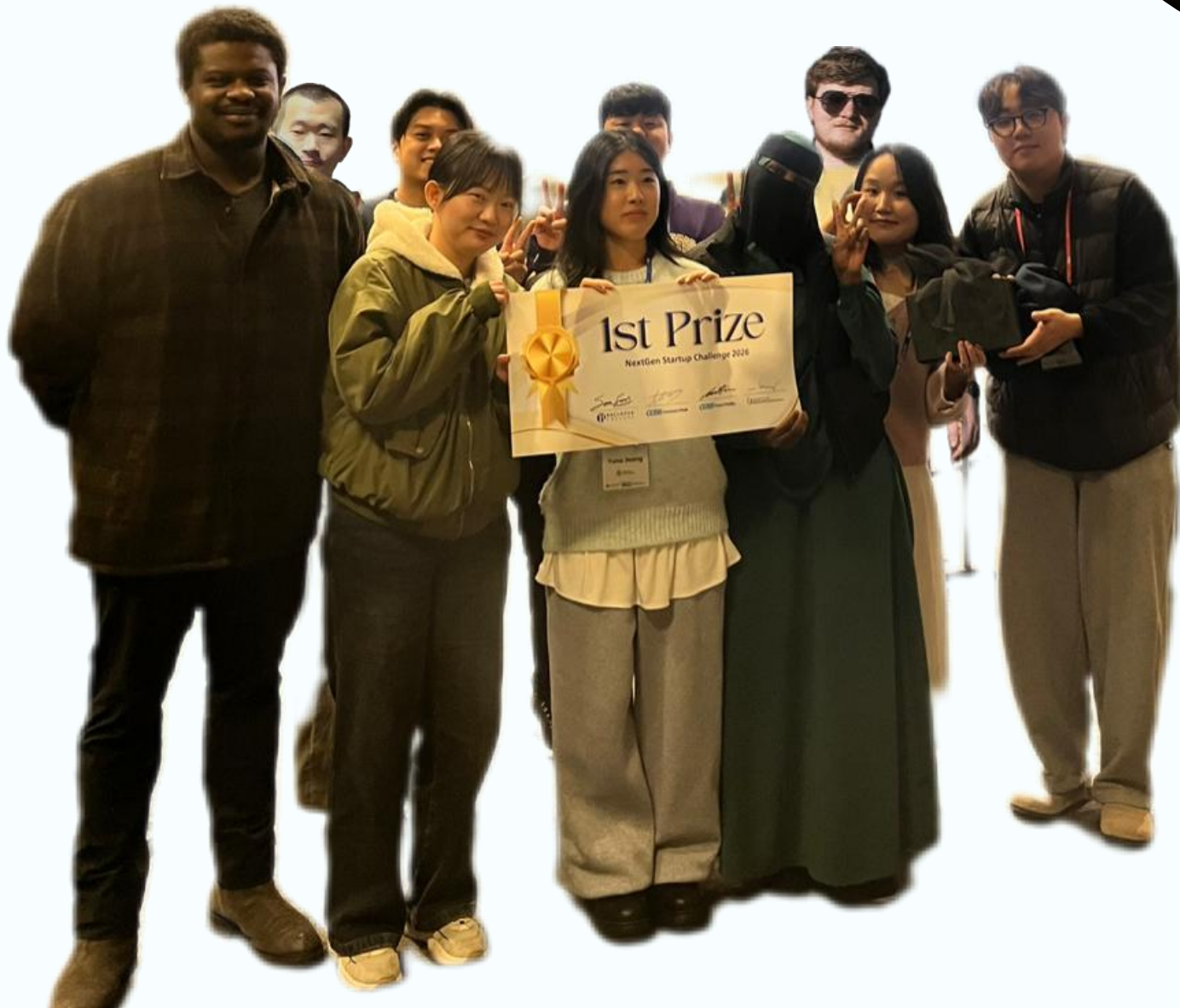
Wayn
e



Nola



Taylor





Y o u r
C o m p a n i o n

R e l i a b l e

S o u n d S y n c

Sound Sync

Dongyun, Sol, Suhyun, Yuna, Taein, Abshira, Nolan, Taylor, Tony, Wayne